

Τελέστης ὁ Σελινουντίος

The Flute and Musical Rivalry of Telestes of Selinus

eul_aid: crg

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Αἰολική](#) [Aeolic](#) ([frg](#))
Domain: [Ποίησις](#) [Poetry](#)
Format: [Ἑμμετρος](#) [Verse](#)

Telestes of Selinus was a Greek lyric poet active in the late 5th century BCE. He came from Selinus, a Doric colony in Sicily, and ancient sources place him as a contemporary of the poet Melanippides. The Suda records that he was victorious in musical competitions, though other biographical details are scarce.

His work survives only in fragments. Telestes composed dithyrambs, hymns, and encomia; the titles of two dithyrambs, Argo and Asclepius, are preserved. A few fragments of his poetry are quoted by later authors like Athenaeus.

Telestes is significant for his role in the evolution of the dithyramb. He is grouped with innovative poets like Philoxenus and Timotheus, who were criticized for introducing complex musical styles. His dithyramb Argo is the earliest known treatment of the Argonautic myth in the genre, expanding its thematic range beyond Dionysiac subjects.

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